

What is Phishing?

Phishing is a **cyber attack** where attackers trick users into revealing **personal or confidential information** (like passwords, credit card numbers, or bank details) by pretending to be a trustworthy source.

Goal of Phishing:

- Steal sensitive information
- Install malware
- Gain unauthorized access to systems

Example:

An email pretending to be from your bank asking you to “verify your account.”

How Phishing Works

1. **Bait** – Attacker sends an email, message, or fake website link.
2. **Hook** – Victim clicks on the link or opens an attachment.
3. **Catch** – Victim unknowingly gives away information or installs malware.

Recognizing Phishing Emails

Look out for these red flags:

- ✗ Unusual sender address (e.g., “support@paypa1.com”)
- ✗ Generic greetings like “Dear user” instead of your name
- ✗ Urgent or threatening language (“Your account will be closed!”)
- ✗ Suspicious links or attachments
- ✗ Poor grammar or spelling errors

Example:

“Dear Customer, your account is suspended. Click here to update your details.”

Spotting Fake Websites

Clues of a Fake Site:

-  URL mismatches (e.g., “www.bank-secure-login.com” instead of “www.bank.com”)
-  Missing HTTPS or invalid security certificate
-  Poor design or broken images
-  Asking for unnecessary personal info

Tip:

Hover your mouse over links **before clicking** — check if the real address matches what’s displayed.

Social Engineering Tactics

Attackers manipulate human psychology to gain trust.

Common Tactics:

- **Authority:** “This is your manager, send the report now.”
- **Urgency:** “Act immediately or lose access!”
- **Fear:** “Your account has been compromised.”
- **Greed:** “You’ve won a free iPhone!”

Best Practices to Stay Safe

- ✓ Think before you click.**
- ✓ Verify the sender** via phone or official contact methods.
- ✓ Check URLs carefully.**
- ✓ Never share passwords** via email or messages.
- ✓ Keep software and antivirus updated.**
- ✓ Use multi-factor authentication (MFA).**

Real-World Examples

1. PayPal Phishing Scam (2022):

Fake PayPal emails asked users to “verify accounts.” Thousands lost access to accounts.

2. COVID-19 Vaccine Phish:

Attackers sent fake vaccine registration links to steal data.

3. Amazon Delivery Scam:

Fake delivery notice emails led to malicious login pages.

Interactive Quiz (Sample Questions)

1. Which of the following is a sign of a phishing email?

- A) Personalized greeting
- B) Urgent request to click a link ☒
- C) Official company domain

2. What should you do if you receive a suspicious email?

- A) Reply to confirm details
- B) Delete it and report to IT ☒
- C) Forward to your friend

3. What is the safest way to access your bank account?

- A) Click a link in the email
- B) Use the official app or type the URL manually ☒

Reporting Phishing Attempts

If you suspect phishing:

-  Do **not** reply or click links.
-  Take a screenshot.
-  Report to your IT/security team or official email (e.g., reportphishing@company.com).
-  Delete the message.

Summary

- Phishing = psychological manipulation + fake digital communication.
- Always **verify before trusting**.
- Stay alert, stay informed, and **never share sensitive data** carelessly.
- Remember: “**When in doubt, throw it out.**”